

Additional resources

For school managements, many open source tools to organise different aspects of the working of an educational institution are listed at www.edutools.info/feature_list.jsp?pj=4&f=823.

2.4 Open Source for IT professionals

2.4.1 Integrated development environments

Eclipse (<http://www.eclipse.org/>)

Eclipse is an open source IDE that can be used for creating applications in languages such as Java, C/C++ and PHP.

However, the emphasis is on Java. Since Eclipse itself is written in Java, it will run on any system containing the Java Runtime Environment (JRE). Another popular open source Java IDE is Netbeans (www.netbeans.org).

Comparatively, there are fewer open source IDEs for non open source languages. For .NET languages, Sharpdevelop (www.icsharpcode.net/OpenSource/SD) is an open source application that can work with VB.NET and C#.

There are many open source IDEs for web based languages such as HTML, PHP and Python. Komodo Edit (www.activestate.com/komodo_edit) is one that can handle all those mentioned, and also Perl, Ruby and Tcl.

Similar is the case with tools to test web applications and web sites. A long list of such applications are listed at www.opensourcetesting.org. Universal modelling language (UML) is an part of software development. ArgoUML (<http://argouml.tigris.org>) is an open source UML modelling tool that runs in any Java environment.

2.5 Open source for scientists

2.5.1 Statistical data analysis

No research is complete without statistically testing the findings for significance. The statistical tools landscape is populated with proprietary statistical packages such as SPSS, though open source applications have started making their presence felt.

R (www.r-project.org) is a multiplatform tool for statistical analysis. R is inspired by the well known S language developed at Bell Labs in the 70s. S is now sold by the name S-plus by Tibco Software. PSPP (www.gnu.org/software/pspp) is another